



Safa: Data analysts are essential in the cloud

Hi, I'm Safa.

I'm a product analyst at Alphabet.

Doing work that feels meaningful is what excites me the most about my job.

One thing that my parents did give me.

Their intentions in giving me a computer was for me to do well in my studies so that I can research things, do my homework better.

But what they didn't realize was that the computer was a **vortex** into online connections.

And I think just by **virtue** of spending so much time on the computer, I found myself really good at tech skills.

When it came time to going to college and deciding, "Oh shoot, what do I wanna study now?," I knew I wanted to do something within tech.

I think cloud is an exciting career space because if we're talking, especially around data analytics and we're thinking about where we can host data on the cloud.

There's gonna be trillions of records of data on the cloud and we're gonna need folks who have that analytics or data knack to be

able to know how to report on it, to be able to know how to engineer ways for that data to live on the cloud.

And so, I think if someone is interested in being a part of the cloud, especially as a

data analyst, I feel like there would be a lot of opportunities to **mend** those two ways to together.

Cloud makes it possible for a lot of people to do their job well, (chuckling) so it is an exciting place to be at.

In my job, especially as a data analyst, it's really important to have a reliable and robust way for having our

data organized, for having our data able to be accessed, to have an intuitive way to query and report on that information.

The cloud makes that possible for us because we're able to use tools like **BigQuery** that allows me to query that data

and find where those **tables are accessed** and it creates like a platform for us to have our data warehouse on it.

And it's fast and it makes it a lot easier.

And I've been in jobs before where we didn't have something like that.

I think a lot of folks, especially at Google, 'cause everyone is so smart and just so hardworking, I think we all probably are going through something

or another and doubting ourselves and feeling like, "I'm not as smart as a person next to me. I'm not as hardworking as a person next to me."

When I had first started at Google, I mean I, like many other folks, I had so much **imposter syndrome**.

I thought they made a mistake hiring me.

'Cause I was not the traditional person that I had attributed as someone who gets hired into Google, which is the Harvard graduate, the person who got amazing grades, who was **valedictorian**.

And here I was, high school dropout.

If you want a product to reach multiple people as Google products do, then you need diverse people working on it.

So yeah, I think it's super important for folks of non-traditional backgrounds to have their voices be

heard and their opinions to be inputted and **woven** into products because it makes for a better product.

A piece of advice that I would share for folks doing the certificate when moments of self-doubt come up, is reminding yourself that you are **incredible**.

Trusting that **gut** instinct that led you to this certificate in the first place is important to hear and honor.

I feel like for me, coming back to that place of, there's a reason why I'm doing this and I know I like this stuff.

And I know myself well enough to know that this is just a momentary wave and if I

ride this wave through, I'll go back to that same place of feeling excited by this topic again.